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How to Use Claude Better than 99% of People (Beginner to Pro)

Learn how you can turn Claude into your personal AI assistant, automated system, researcher, operator, and more.



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373



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Let me be brutally honest, most people are still using Claude just for chatting with it.

They open it, ask random questions, generate some content, and then close it.

That's like having a genius employee... and only asking them for Google-level answers.

Meanwhile, the Claude team has launched tons of insane features that only a small group of people are using to:

- run entire workflows
- automate thinking

- build products
- save 10–20 hours every single week

The difference is simply in how they use it as a system builder, workflow engine, and thinking partner.

And after going deep into Claude's ecosystem, I'm writing this post to help you understand and use all the insane features it has.

Note: *This post was originally published in my newsletter, AI Made Simple. It's basically where I document what actually works for me with AI, in real workflows.*

With that said, let's get started.

1. Claude Projects = Your Personal AI Brain

You know, most people:

- upload files again and again
- repeat context
- waste time and credits

Instead, you should use Projects inside Claude.



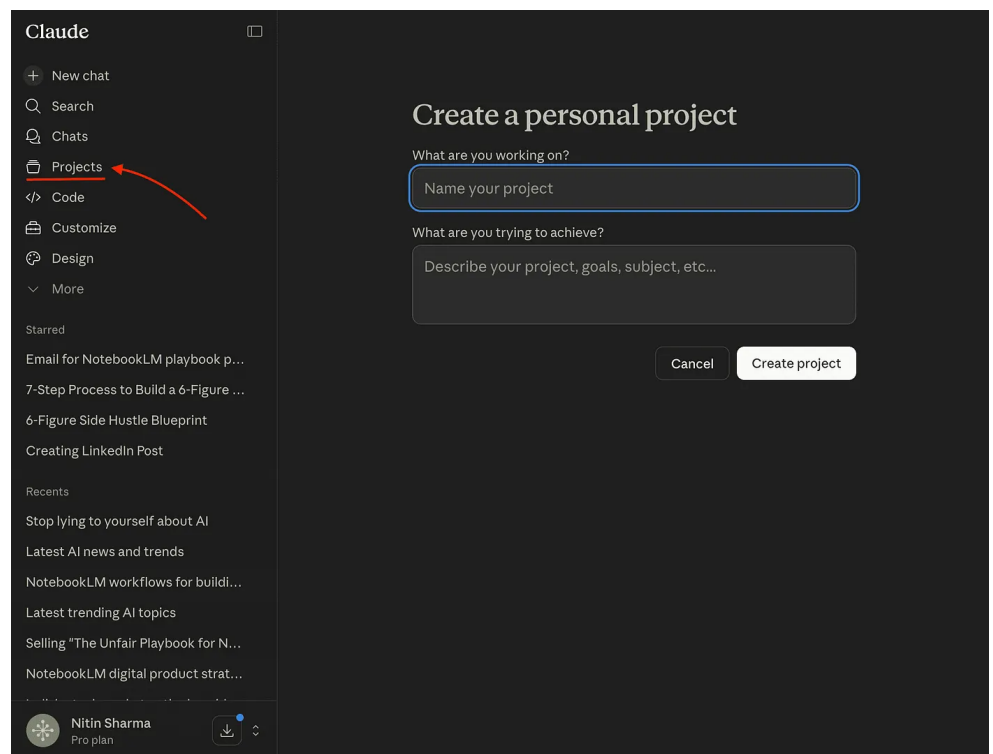
Anthropic



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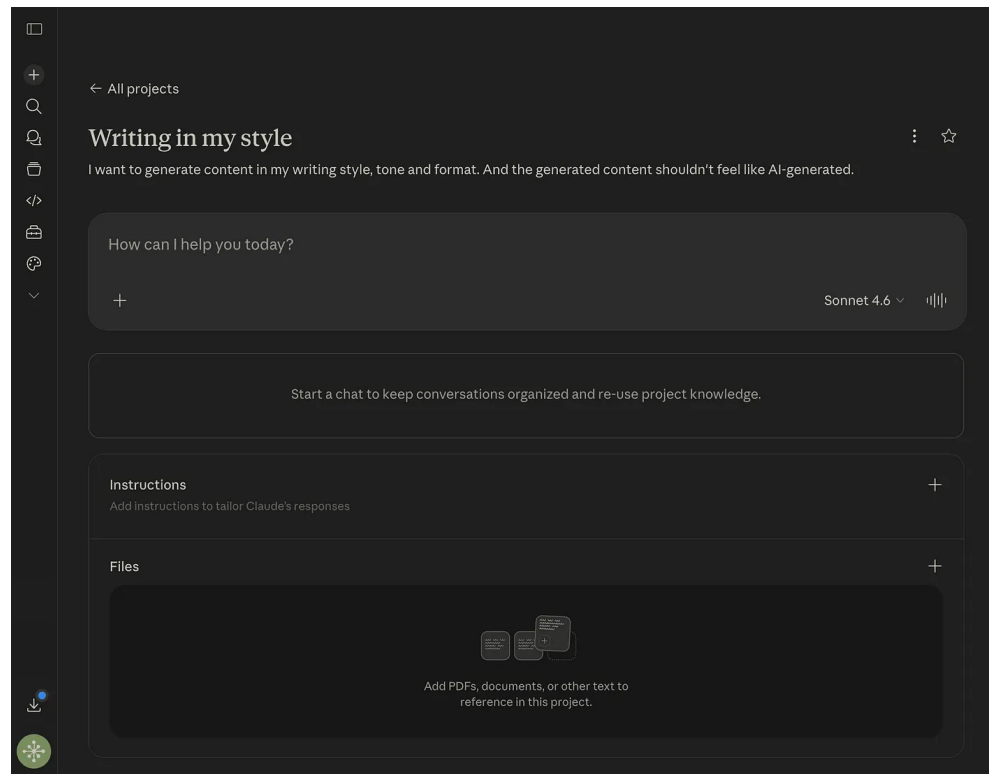
What it actually is: A persistent environment where Claude remembers everything. You can think of it like a custom GPT, but smarter and actually usable daily.

How to use it (step-by-step):



1. Create a new project

2. Add your documents, scripts, research, notes, and so on
3. Add instructions like your writing style, audience, and tone
4. Then reuse it forever



Real Use Case:

I use this for generating content, and inside my project, I've uploaded my past viral posts, frameworks, and tone instructions.

Then I just say: “Create a new post in my style on X topic.”

And it works like a trained assistant.

Why this matters:

Instead of starting from scratch every time, I now have a trained AI that gets better over time.

Just so you know:

Everything I've shared here is something I actually use.

If this post changed how you think about AI even a little, that didn't happen in isolation. It came from a much bigger shift in how I use AI overall.

*That's why I put that entire system down inside "**The (Unfair) AI Workflow Playbook**" with everything you need.*

It's the exact set of workflows I use daily to run my work faster than feels normal, and if you apply even a few of them, you'll save hundreds of hours.

You can spend months figuring this out on your own, or you can steal my entire playbook right now.

2. Claude Code = Build Stuff Without Being a Genius



Claude



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Most of you may think Claude Code is just for “generating code”.

It’s actually built to help you build apps and websites, debug, iterate, and think through logic right inside your VS Code, even if you’re not a hardcore developer.

But you know what most people do? They prompt like this: “Write me a function.”

What you should do instead is write prompts with better context:

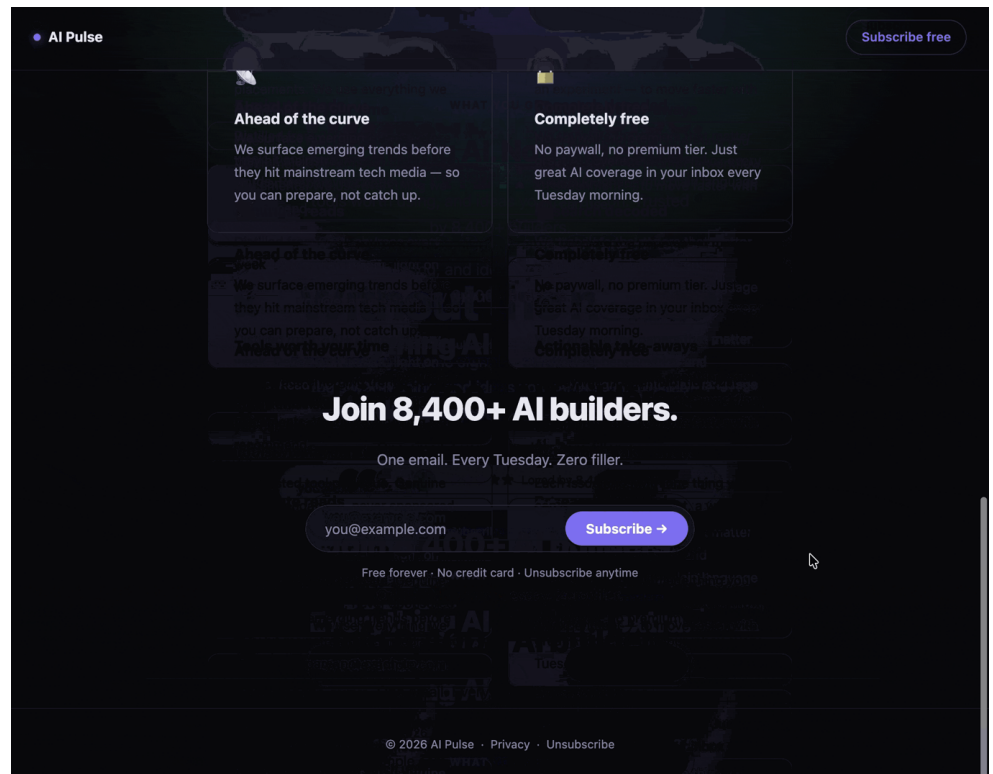
Build a simple landing page for my AI newsletter using HTML + CSS,

optimize for conversion, and add animations + responsiveness.

Include:

- Hero section
- Email capture
- Benefits
- Minimal design

And based on the prompt, here's what it generated:



And if you're a developer, you're no longer just coding by writing tons of lines of code. You're actually shipping faster than most devs and getting more work done in less time.

Why this matters:

You don't need to be a "great developer."

You just need to think clearly and guide the AI properly to build the app you want.

3. Build "Skills" = Your Personal Automation System

Yes, Claude even lets you create Skills, which are basically reusable workflows to automate tasks.



Claude

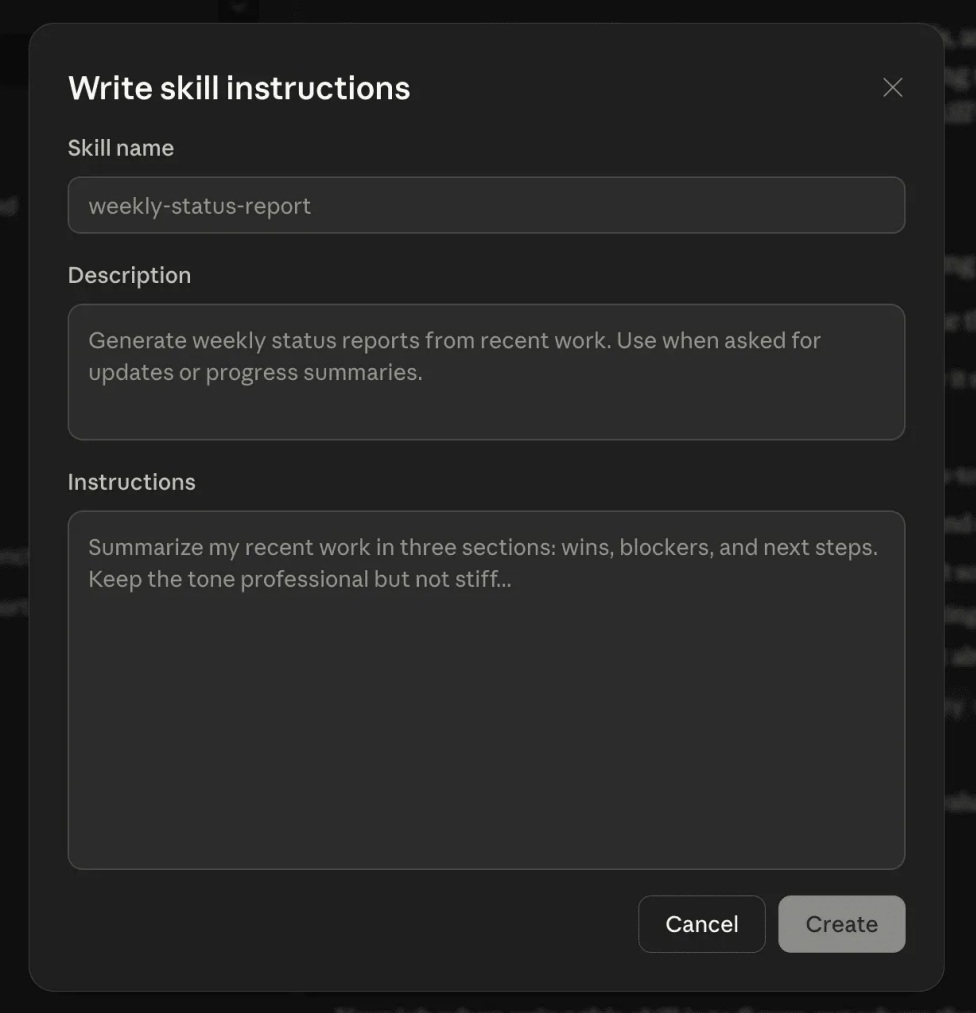


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More precisely, it is a pre-defined instruction written by you that Claude executes automatically to get the job done.

For example:

Instead of writing a prompt like this every time: “Turn this blog into a LinkedIn post with a hook, insights, and CTA.”



Write skill instructions ✕

Skill name

weekly-status-report

Description

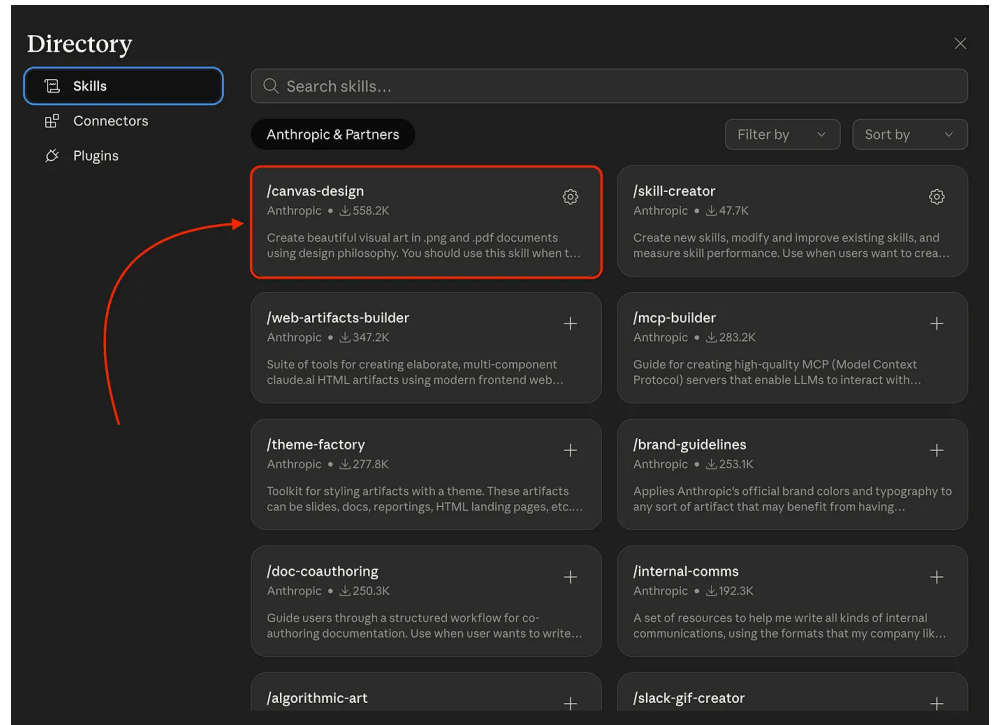
Generate weekly status reports from recent work. Use when asked for updates or progress summaries.

Instructions

Summarize my recent work in three sections: wins, blockers, and next steps. Keep the tone professional but not stiff...

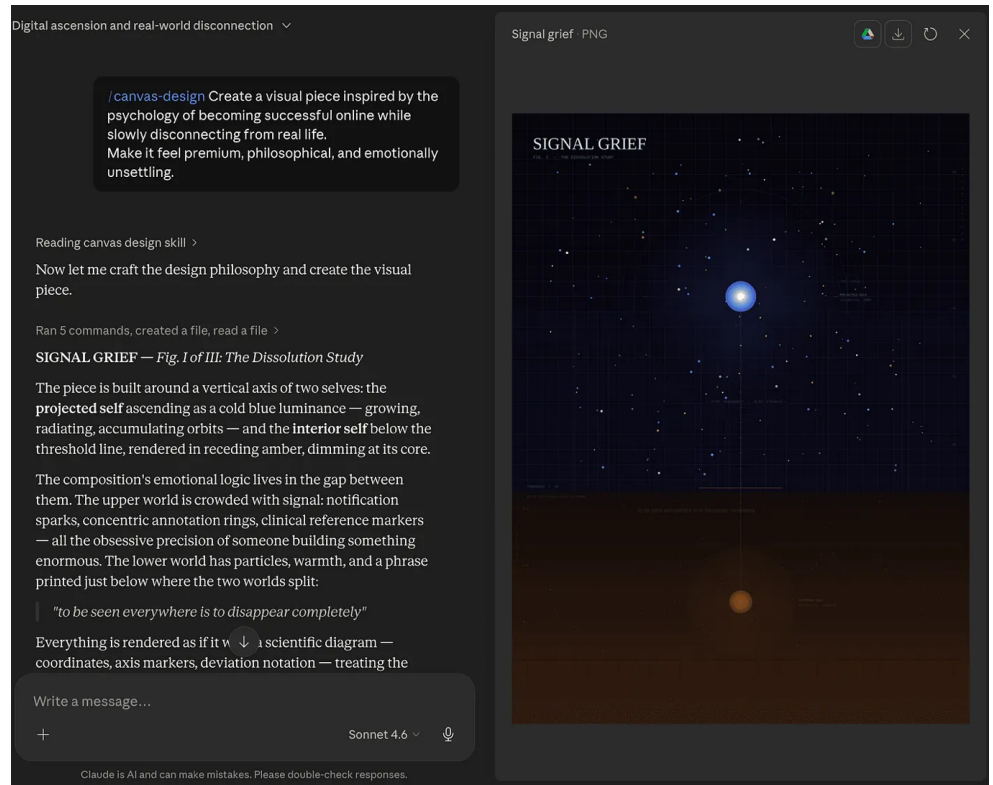
Cancel Create

You can create a Skill by defining the skill name, the description, and then giving instructions about what it needs to do.



I've simply browsed a Claude Skill called “canvas-design” and wrote a prompt to try it out.

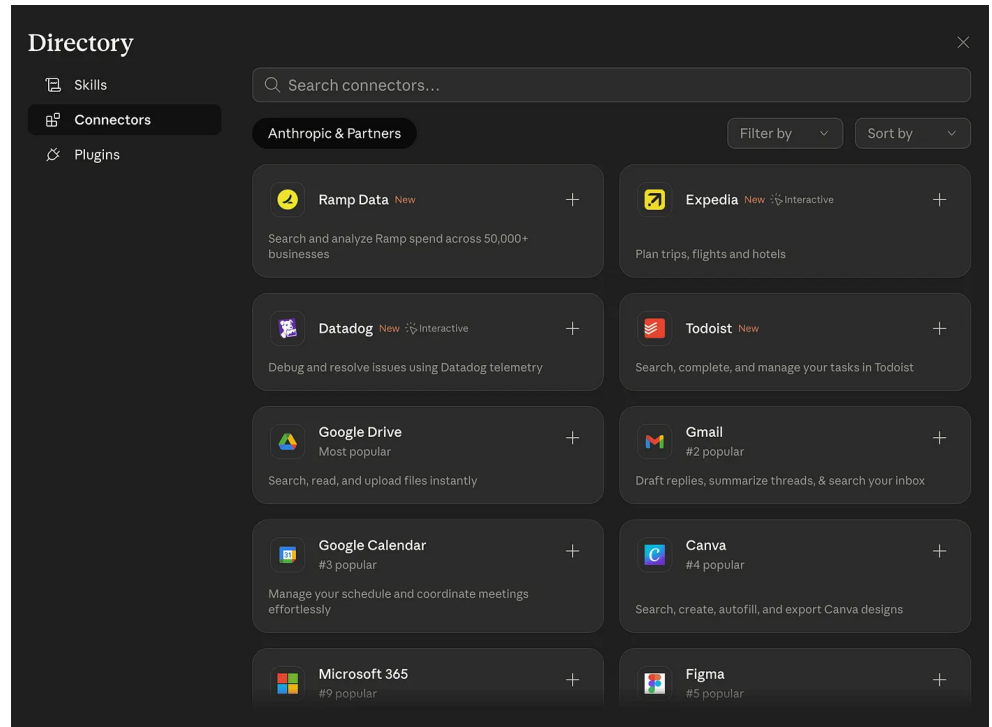
Here's what it generated:



You see, with Claude Skills, it generated an abstract visual philosophy exactly the way I wanted.

4. Use Connectors = Claude Becomes Your Assistant

This is where Claude becomes dangerous (in a good way).



You can now connect Claude to Gmail, Google Drive, Calendar, GitHub, and more.

And ask it to assist with tedious tasks like:

1. Find emails that need urgent replies
2. Summarize my inbox
3. Schedule meetings for this week

And Claude literally reads, filters, and acts to get the work done.





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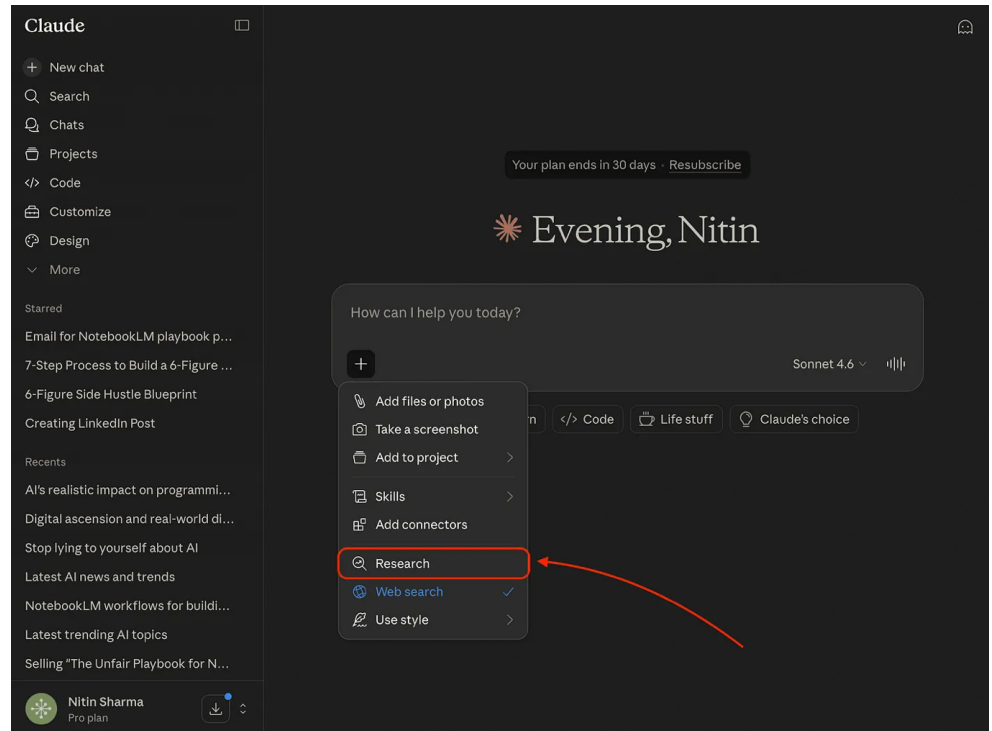
You can also check your calendar, schedule meetings, pull docs from Drive, and more.

It even lets you read documents, analyze spreadsheets, create PPTs, generate reports, and more.

You see, this is how Claude with connectors can start behaving like an executive assistant.

5. Research Mode = Replace 10 Tabs With One Prompt

Most people still search on Google, open 5 tabs, skim everything, and waste their time.

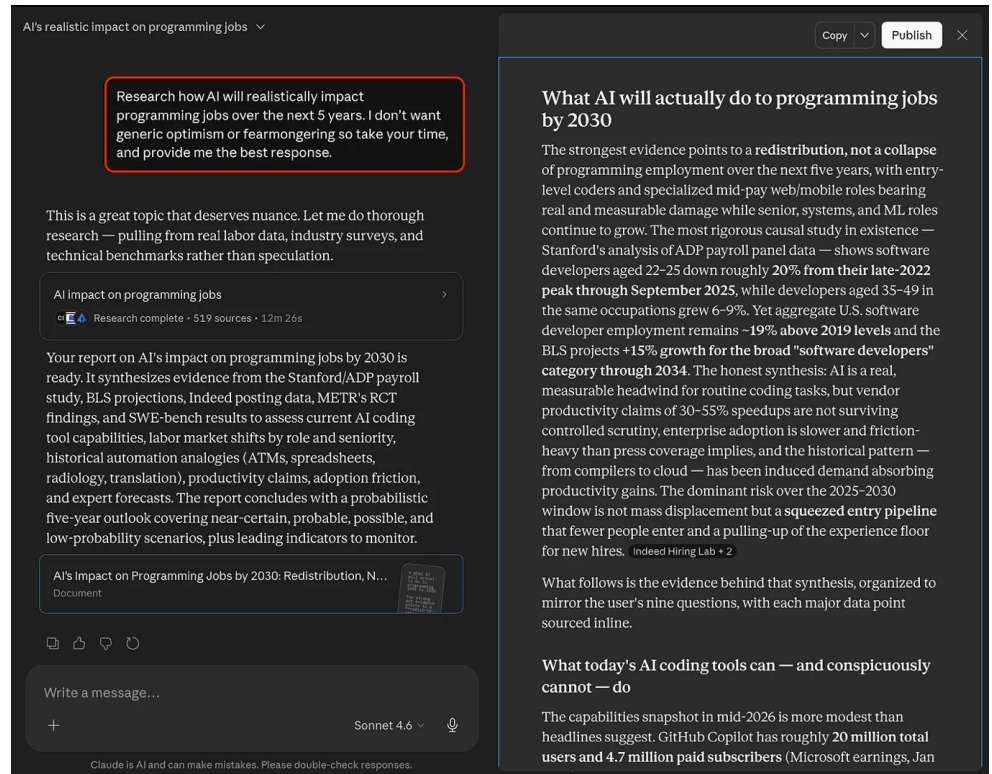


Instead, you can use the Research Mode inside Claude by giving some context like your budget, the features you want, why you want it, and so on.

Example prompt:

Research how AI will realistically impact programming jobs over the next 5 years. I don't want generic optimism or fearmongering, so take your time and provide me with the best response.

What next? Claude searches multiple sources, compares options, filters information, and gives you what you need.



The best part? You just skipped hours of research, skimming through 20 to 30 tabs, and a lot of confusion.

If you want to learn more about it, here's a video for you:



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6. Claude CoWork = Turn Claude Into an Operator

Claude CoWork does something far more dangerous i.e., it executes.

And this is where 99% of people completely miss the point.

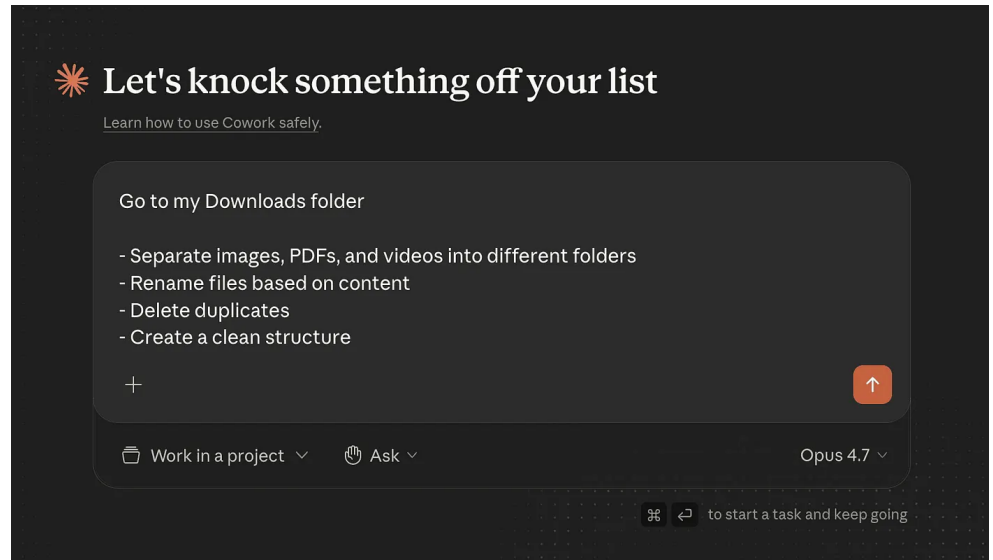
Because they're still manually organizing files, renaming images, uploading stuff, and moving folders when Claude CoWork can do that in seconds.

Yes, Claude can literally do all of that for you.

So instead of asking, "How do I organize my files?" simply use Claude CoWork and say:

Go to my Downloads folder:

- Separate images, PDFs, and videos into different folders
- Rename files based on content
- Delete duplicates
- Create a clean structure



Claude CoWork does that, and you can even schedule tasks like asking:

Every day at 10 AM:

- Find the top AI news from the last 24 hours
- Turn them into short scripts
- Save them in a PDF file on my desktop

Here's the output it sends me everyday at 10 AM:

AI News Brief — Broadcast Script

Top stories from the last 24 hours · May 6, 2026 · Runtime: ~3 minutes

[ANCHOR ON CAMERA]

Good evening, and welcome to your AI Daily Brief. I'm your anchor, and these are the stories shaping artificial intelligence right now. Tonight: Washington tightens its grip on frontier models, China floods the open-weights market, and pharma places its biggest AI bet yet. Let's get to it.

Story 1 — Washington moves into AI oversight

Our top story: the Trump administration is stepping deeper into AI oversight. The newly established Center for AI Standards and Innovation has signed agreements with Google DeepMind, Microsoft, and xAI to evaluate their frontier models *before* public release. Officials say the goal is pre-deployment testing of safety and capabilities.

Story 2 — Pentagon picks its AI partners — and snubs Anthropic

In a related move, the Pentagon has inked classified-network deals with eight tech giants — OpenAI, Google, Microsoft, Nvidia, Amazon Web Services, Oracle, SpaceX, and Reflection. Notably absent: Anthropic, reportedly blacklisted over its insistence on safety guardrails for military AI use.

Story 3 — OpenAI ships low-latency voice AI

OpenAI today detailed how it's delivering low-latency voice AI at scale — a push to make real-time voice agents feel as natural as a phone call, and a direct shot at the next interface battleground.

Story 4 — China's open-weights surge

Across the Pacific, four Chinese labs have dropped open-weight coding models in just twelve days: Z.ai's GLM-5.1, MiniMax M2.7, Moonshot's Kimi K2.6, and DeepSeek V4. All landed at roughly the same agentic-engineering ceiling as Western frontier models — at less than a third of the inference cost.

Story 5 — Anthropic upgrades Claude

Anthropic rolled out keyless authentication for the Claude Platform, supporting browser-based CLI login and workload identity federation across AWS, GCP, and Azure. The company also shipped a new tokenizer for Claude Opus 4.7, sharpening how the model reads inputs.



Claude



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And then comes Dispatch, which can trigger tasks from your phone like:

- Upload the top AI news PDF file to Google Drive
- Copy the link
- Send it back to me

And Claude handles everything in the background. You don't even need to sit at your desk.

7. Claude Design = Turn Ideas Into Real Designs

Most people still think design means:

- opening Figma
- dragging boxes for 3 hours
- watching YouTube tutorials
- hiring expensive designers for basic stuff

Meanwhile, smart users have started using Claude Design to turn rough ideas into real designs in minutes.

And no, I'm not talking about "make me a pretty UI."

I'm talking about generating actual landing pages, app layouts, dashboards, wireframes, brand directions, and marketing assets with clear thinking and good prompts.

This is where Claude starts feeling like a product

designer sitting beside you, helping you generate designs even if you're a non-designer.

The screenshot shows the Claude AI interface. On the left, the 'App onboarding' sidebar is visible with a chat history for 'AI Resume Builder Lan...'. The main chat area shows a conversation between 'You' and 'Claude'. 'You' has provided a prompt: 'Design a modern landing page for my AI resume builder targeted at college students. The goal is to maximize signups. Include: clean hero section with strong headline, social proof, before/after resume example, pricing section, FAQ, modern SaaS-style UI, mobile-first layout, colors optimized for trust and simplicity.' 'Claude' has responded: 'I'll design a modern landing page for your AI resume builder. Let me ask a few quick questions to nail the direction, then build.' Below this is a button that says 'Claude has some questions →'. At the bottom of the chat area is a text input field 'Describe what you want to create...' and buttons for 'Import' and 'Send'.

The right panel is titled 'Quick questions about the AI resume builder landing page'. It contains several sections of questions with multiple-choice options:

- What's the product name?**
I'll use a placeholder like 'Resumely' if you skip
Input field: Resumely
- Color direction**
All optimized for trust + simplicity
Options: Calm indigo + warm white (classic SaaS trust), Forest green + cream (growth, calm), Deep navy + soft peach accent (premium, friendly), Near-black + single bright accent (minimal, confident), Explore a few options, Decide for me, Other...
- Copy tone**
Options: Friendly + casual (talks like a peer), Confident + professional, Bold + punchy (Gen Z energy), Decide for me, Other...
- What kind of social proof?**
Options: Student count / stats, University logos (placeholder), Student testimonials with avatars, Companies students got into (placeholder logos), Star rating / reviews, All of the above, Decide for me, Other...

At the bottom right of the questionnaire is a 'Continue' button.

Here's the prompt you can try:

Design a modern landing page for my AI resume builder targeted at college students.

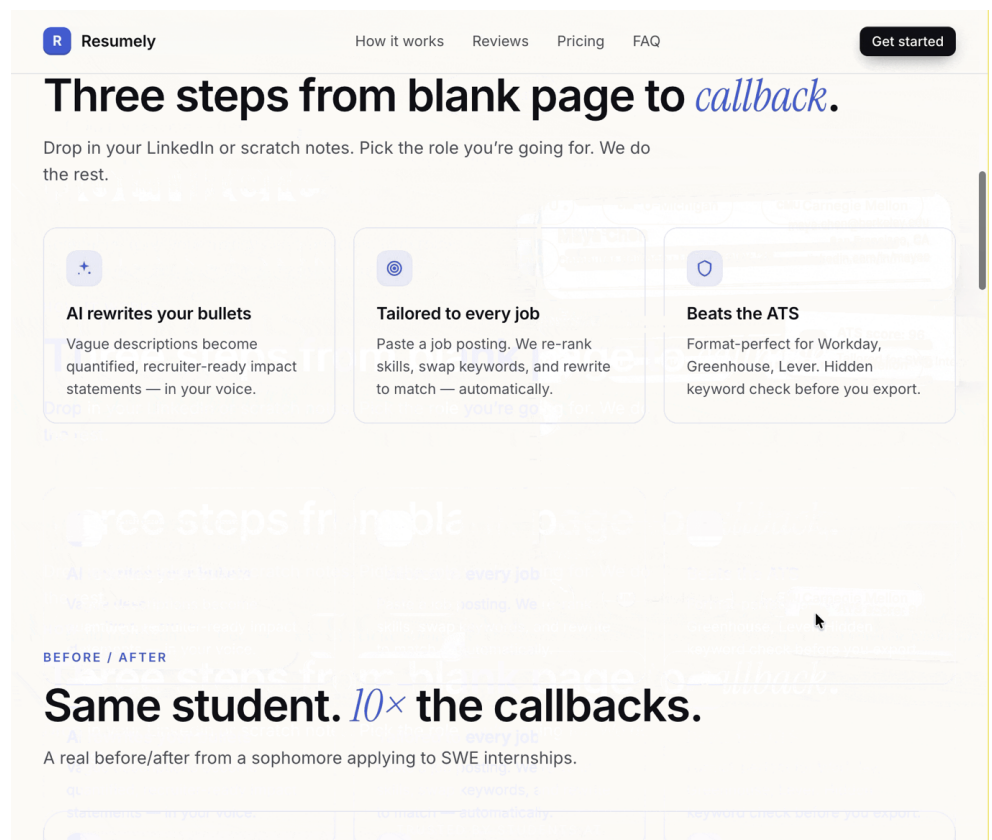
The goal is to maximize signups.

Include:

- clean hero section with strong headline

- social proof
- before/after resume example
- pricing section
- FAQ
- modern SaaS-style UI
- mobile-first layout
- colors optimized for trust and simplicity

Based on the prompt, here's what it generated:



Why this matters:

You see, you no longer need to be:

- a professional designer
- a UI expert
- a Figma wizard

You just need to think clearly about the user experience you want to create.

And Claude helps turn that thinking into something visual, structured, and buildable.

Hope you like it.

If this resonated with you, share it with someone who needs to read it, since most people want to learn practically about AI but won't access posts like this.

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📄 Stories

📊 Stats

And that's where you can help someone you care about use AI practically and get ahead.

Also, don't forget to checkout "[The \(Unfair\) AI Workflow Playbook](#)" where I shared exact set of AI workflows I use daily to run my work faster than feels normal.

- Following
- Dev Genius
- Python in Plain En...
- Generative AI
- Realworld AI Use C...
- The Useful Tech
- Level Up Coding
- AI Mind
- Deep concept
- Top Python Librari...
- The Mac Alchemist
- More

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Written by Nitin Sharma

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Responses (5)

 Pancake Agree

What are your thoughts?

 Barney Lerten

May 7

...

This is a super summarization.!

 4 [Reply](#)

 Tomas Staniulis he

May 9

...

Pefert read for a lazy saturday! keep writing :)

 1 [Reply](#)

 Muhammad Arslan Nawaz he/him

May 9

...

Thanks

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